SUNDAY NIGHT LIGHTS

OFFICIAL LEAGUE RULES / 2026-27 FALL / MARKHAM SPORTS DOME

Revised: November 7, 2026 **Competition: F26 | 6 teams | 10 playing Sundays**

LEAGUE FORMAT

Six teams play a 10-Sunday regular season, with no games on December 27, 2026. Each team plays two games per playing Sunday against different opponents (20 regular-season games per team; 60 games league-wide). Each pairing meets four times, twice with each team designated home.

STANDINGS POINTS & TIEBREAKERS

Points: Win = 2; Tie = 1; Loss = 0. Teams are ranked by the criteria below, in order.

1. Most standings points (PTS).

2. Most regular-season wins (W).

3. Most head-to-head points earned among the tied teams.

4. Highest regular-season capped run differential (RD +/-7): cap each game at +7 or -7, then add those values.

5. Fewest regular-season runs allowed (RA).

6. Most regular-season runs scored (RF).

7. Draw required if the teams remain tied after all other criteria.

The uncapped RD statistic is informational; capped RD +/-7 is the run-differential tiebreaker used for league rankings and playoff seeding.

PLAYOFFS - SERIES & INNINGS

The top two regular-season seeds receive quarterfinal byes. All rounds are best-of-three; Game 3 is played only if necessary. Home assignments follow the approved playoff schedule.

ROUND	MATCHUPS	SERIES	REGULATION INNINGS
Quarterfinals	#3 vs #6; #4 vs #5	Best of 3	6 full innings
Semifinals	#1 vs lowest remaining seed; #2 vs other remaining	Best of 3	7 full innings
Championship	Semifinal winners	Best of 3	7 full innings

Playoff ties: No playoff game may end tied. In extra innings, begin with the last batter on second base and no outs. The applicable playoff mercy rules still apply.

GAME FORMAT & BATTING

1. Batting lineups may be any length; there is no limit.

2. All balls are live. A fair ball hitting the dome and caught in the air is an out. Balls into or under bleachers or soccer nets are subject to umpire discretion (e.g., ground-rule double).

3. Regular season: Games are 35 minutes or six innings, whichever comes first; no new inning begins after 30 minutes. If play exceeds 35 minutes, scores revert to the previous inning. **Playoffs:** Quarterfinals are six full innings; semifinals and the final are seven full innings, subject to the applicable mercy rules.

4. Batters start with a 1-1 count (no Mexican). A wooden board serves as the strike zone. Legal pitches must arc 6-12 feet.

5. Intentional walks are permitted.

6. Any caught foul tip is an out.

7. Home runs must be scored inside the park.

RUNNERS & DEFENCE

8. Courtesy runners: Unlimited during the regular season. In playoffs, maximum five per game; a courtesy runner cannot receive a courtesy runner. A player may run multiple times but not twice in the same inning. Injured players must be declared at the start of the game; one courtesy is deducted per injured player per at-bat. If injury occurs on a play, a courtesy runner is required; if none remain, the last person out runs.

9. Any defence is permitted, including a five-player infield. When bases are empty, the fifth infielder (between shortstop and second) may not throw to first; this restriction ends if a runner is on base. Ten defenders may be on the field. Outfielders may throw out a runner at first when a player is already on base.

10. The commitment line is in effect (marked by cones). Sliding is allowed, including at home; touching home plate is an out.

11. No bunting or chopped swings; the batter is out.

MERCY RULES, TIES & SUBSTITUTIONS

12. Five-run limit per inning; last inning is open. **Regular season:** No game-ending mercy rule. **Playoffs:** Mercy applies at a 20-run lead after four innings or a 15-run lead after five.

13. Regular-season games may end tied. Playoff games cannot; use the extra-inning runner rule above.

14. Playoff-only substitution rule: One substitute per game; no re-entry after replacement. A player may be added at any point, including to the batting order after play begins.

ELIGIBILITY & SPORTSMANSHIP

15. Players may play only for their rostered teams. No picking up or sharing players from other or eliminated teams.

16. Umpires' decisions are final.

17. Arrive at the diamond on time; games begin promptly and may start early if possible.

Most importantly - have fun!

This version reflects the approved 2026-27 Fall league format and the confirmed six-inning quarterfinal / seven-inning semifinal and championship rules. For a game-day dispute, confirm the ruling with SNL league officials.